hūmānus

update since 29 June · Q3 2026 Board Meeting

29 October 2026

Humanising Justice

ACCOUNTABILITY · COMMUNITY · EVIDENCE

Sponsor: Eva Buzo, Executive Director · Agenda item [Eva to confirm] · 15 minutes · Discussion · DRAFT for ED sign-off

Three goals guide everything we do

Our 2024–29 strategy frames the year.

1

Victims secure outcomes in line with their own conception of justice.

2

Victims are empowered by the process of pursuing justice — not just by its results.

3

Justice processes are transformed to put victims at the centre.

The September retreat proposed broadening our framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations (slide 10). [Eva to confirm: Note or Endorse on 29 Oct agenda]

Where the work has sat since June

29 June – 12 October 2026, by funded programme and other significant strands.

Programme / strand	Funder	Status since 29 June
Rohingya in India — legal protection	Core funding	Delhi detention roundtable convened lawyers (5 Jul); Right to Education route for detained minors developed; habeas and bail filings in preparation.
Bangladesh dialogue	FCDO (UK)	Phase I delivery continuing; inputs to Stimson-led interim report (Jun–Oct); Jun–Oct financial claim in preparation.
Towards a More Peaceful Arakan	Swiss FDFA via Stimson Center	Rohingya dialogue continuing; RCC roundtable on conditions for return at UNGA (25 Sep).
Accountability for business and human rights	Core funding	Meta response to our case; Amnesty × hūmānus UNGA side event; Adani research dossier.
Public engagement	Core funding	Against the Tide swim (Small Islands Coalition, Seychelles, UNGA); Berkeley keynote (28 Sep).
Research — Rohingya analysis	[Eva to confirm]	Sawyeddollah's analysis reports on Rohingya; website in development.

Women's Dialogue (SDC) closed 30 April 2026; no activity this period. [Eva to confirm] Finance: see Stacy McGill's Q3 Board Finance Report and Forecast Report.

Rohingya in India — legal protection

Core funded · no project grant · Lead: Arati Ranade, India Programme Manager

What the strand is

Direct legal intervention for detained Rohingya refugees in India, building a cross-state network of lawyers and an evidentiary base on detention and deportation patterns. Funded from core — no donor restriction on case selection or strategy.

Since 29 June

- Delhi detention roundtable (5 July) — lawyers from across states convened over three panels to discuss detention litigation strategy.
- Right to Education — strategy note drafted on an education-rights route for detained minors, alongside the refugee route; raised with African states in Geneva (25 August).
- Litigation pipeline — habeas corpus petition in drafting; bail application being finalised for counsel's review; Right to Information petitioner being identified.
- Lawyer network — Jammu & Kashmir leads in place; Rajasthan, Tripura and Hyderabad being assessed. Case-law report on Rohingya deportation in preparation.

Why this matters for the board

The retreat agreed to continue the lawyer-network approach and reassess the Rohingya project after six months (slide 10). [Eva to confirm: report the review in writing or verbally]

Bangladesh dialogue programme

FCDO (UK) · continuing programme

What the funding supports

Sustained dialogue and engagement work with Rohingya leadership in Bangladesh, complementing the Swiss/Stimson Arakan partnership. Operates in a deficit / reimbursement model — hūmānus spends and is reimbursed in arrears.

Since 29 June

- Phase I delivery continuing.
- hūmānus inputs being prepared for the Stimson-led FCDO interim report covering June–October.
- June–October financial claim being prepared in GBP; Schedule 2 disbursement amounts being agreed and countersigned.
- Cash timing — Stacy McGill's Q3 report shows the FCDO Phase II claim as the next contracted receipt, indicatively November.

Towards a More Peaceful Arakan

Swiss FDFA, via Stimson Center as prime · hūmānus as implementing partner

What the project is

An 18-month partnership (December 2025 – May 2027) to identify, create, and support trust-building opportunities among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh stakeholders, combining bilateral engagement, capacity building, and facilitated dialogue.

Since 29 June

- Rohingya dialogue work continuing with Rohingya leadership.
- UNGA week — RCC High-Level Roundtable, The Conditions for Return: A Rohingya-Led Dialogue (25 September).
- Request made to Stimson for the FDFA head grant and the approved joint workplan.
- Related peace-network engagement — PHRD Myanmar partner discussion (16 July); Pre-Gathering online sessions, Finding Each Other on Shifting Ground (13 and 16 July); Swiss Peace Partners Network, Geneva (6 August). [Eva to confirm placement]

Accountability for business and human rights

Core funded · legal action, regulatory complaint and advocacy — confirmed as a core model at the retreat

THE FRAMEWORK

Bringing together our work that holds business actors accountable for contribution to, or benefit from, serious international crimes — across litigation, regulatory complaint, and investor-facing advocacy.

ACTIVE WORKSTREAMS

Meta / Facebook

Meta has responded to our case, including a request for particulars. [Eva to confirm: source to be supplied] Amnesty × hūmānus and Meta Inc. side events at UNGA (25 Sep); documentary narrative and video series in production.

Adani / UniSuper / APRA

Team research dossier progressing: UniSuper holdings disclosure, super-fund exposure and GQG mandates, Cbus deep dive, OFAC civil probe, Australian fiduciary-duty case law, thermal-coal revenue share, Adani Defence.

Other accountability work

US and UK greenwashing opinions (Reuben brothers / Escénica) in progress. CERD / ICJ brief concerning Australia in preparation.

Note for the Board

At Q2 we proposed a dedicated Adani / UniSuper paper for this meeting. [Eva to confirm: delivered, deferred (with reason) or dropped]

Public engagement

Core funded · Against the Tide, speaking and advocacy

Against the Tide

- Eva Buzo Swim × Small Islands Coalition (28 August); Islands Swim: Seychelles (15 September); small-islands press, social and documentary session at UNGA (25 September).

Speaking and advocacy

- Berkeley (28 September) — keynote, Human Rights for Victims of Conflict in a Fragmenting World; session with Berkeley IIS clinic students on conflict monitoring.
- UNGA week (21–25 September) — Afrobarometer–OSF side event Beyond Borders (24 Sep), OSF reception and network partners dinner, alongside the Amnesty, Meta and RCC events on slides 6 and 7.
- 9th anniversary of the Rohingya genocide (24 August) — communications moment.
- Media bank (B-roll and photography) being built for future communications.

Research — Rohingya analysis

M. Sawyeddollah [Eva to confirm spelling] · funding line [Eva to confirm]

What the strand is

Analysis reports on the Rohingya situation by M. Sawyeddollah, and a website he is building to host the work. [Eva to confirm framing]

Since 29 June

- Analysis papers discussed with him in New York during UNGA week (23 September).
- Website in development. [Eva to confirm launch timing]
- Scope and audience of the reports. [Eva to confirm]

Strategy retreat — what we decided

Team retreat, September 2026 · Day 1: strategy, impact and organisational focus

Strategy and impact

- Plan from what clients need — an outcomes ladder linking litigation, mediation and community engagement to meaningful results.
- Broaden the framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations; stay people-focused and prioritise systemic change. [Eva to confirm: Note or Endorse on 29 Oct agenda]
- Corporate accountability — legal action, regulatory complaints and advocacy — adopted as a core model, including Adani and Facebook.

- Rohingya — continue the lawyer-network and coordination approach; reassess after six months. [Eva to confirm: written or verbal]

Organisational choices

- Be realistic about capacity; close or refocus dormant or ineffective projects without a credible path to impact. [Eva to confirm: name projects or keep principled]
- Keep excellence, rigour and clear accountability central; new geographies only where needs-driven.
- Tell the organisation's story well, show impact to clients and funders; consider dedicated fundraising capacity. [Eva to confirm: decided or exploratory]

Strategy retreat — how we work

Team retreat, September 2026 · Day 2: culture, collaboration and ways of working

Ways of working

- Channels — Motion for tasks and coordination, Signal for quick contact, email for external and out-of-hours.
- Rhythm — full-team meetings fortnightly, project meetings on alternate weeks, 15-minute calls for quick clarification.
- Supportive accountability — flag delays and dependencies early; clear owners, timelines and expectations; setbacks treated as learning.

- Audiences — "humanizing justice" for clients seeking remedies and funders seeking measurable impact; policymakers, lawyers and media as multipliers.
- People — regionally grounded recruitment, internships and fellowships; external mentors and internal peer support.

Follow-up themes

Connect activities and resource requests to client outcomes; reassess work without a realistic route to impact, including the Rohingya project after the review period; strengthen public storytelling; keep refining strategy and practice as capacity evolves.

Strategic outlook and watch-items

Things to keep in view between now and the February 2027 meeting.

Cash position

Cash USD 33,679 at 30 September; no contracted receipts until the FCDO Phase II claim (indicatively November) and OSF Year 3 (January 2027). Per Stacy McGill's Q3 Board Finance Report.

Strategic framing

The retreat proposes broadening the board-approved 2024–29 strategy from serious international crimes to human rights violations. [Eva to confirm: Note or Endorse]

Rohingya programme review

Six-month reassessment agreed in September falls around March 2027, between board meetings. [Eva to confirm: how and when the board hears the outcome]

Prioritisation

Dormant or ineffective projects to be closed or refocused. [Eva to confirm: name projects or keep principled]

Fundraising and post-OSF horizon

Dedicated fundraising capacity under consideration — continues the Q2 item 6 discussion on matching ambition to fundraising. [Eva to confirm: decided or exploratory]

Governance and entity

Legal name change VAI → hūmānus notified to OSF grant contacts; staff contract renewals in progress. Finance detail in Stacy McGill's papers.

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Q3 2026 Board Meeting · Operations & Impact Update · Sponsor: Eva Buzo (ED) · DRAFT